

BEARS

The Ursidae are large, stocky-yet-agile animals native to Europe, Asia, and the Americas. Most bears are omnivorous, with plant material making up most of their diet. However, the polar bear is a specialized meat-eater and the giant panda is almost entirely herbivorous. Bears live alone except for mothers caring for their young.

BROWN BEAR *Ursus arctos*

This bear's vast range, including Asia, N. Europe, and N. America, testifies to its dietary flexibility. It eats seasonal foods, including berries and spawning salmon.

1.2–1.8 m
4–6 ft

1.5–2.8 m
5–9¼ ft

white face with
black eyes and
ears

GIANT PANDA *Ailuropoda melanoleuca*

This endangered bear lives in central Chinese forests. Despite being a carnivore, it eats mostly bamboo; this lack of adequate nutrition results in a low-energy lifestyle.

five claws
grow to
10 cm (4 in)

EARED SEALS

Members of this family are distinguished from true seals by their small external ears and by their limbs, which can be used for moving on land – they are able to walk on their flippers, albeit in an ungainly manner. The Otariidae are excellent swimmers, but their dives are short and shallow compared with those of some true seals. They occur in most oceans except the North Atlantic.

STELLER'S SEA LION *Eumetopias jubatus*

Also known as the northern sea lion, this North Pacific species is the largest of the eared seals. It eats mainly fish, but may take smaller seals.

thick neck

NEW ZEALAND SEA LION *Phocarctos hookeri*

Found only in the waters around New Zealand, this rare species breeds only on a few offshore islands.

1.8–2.7 m
6–8¾ ft

AUSTRALIAN SEA LION *Neophoca cinerea*

This relatively rare species has breeding colonies restricted to Western and South Australia. Small groups stay together even outside the breeding season.

1.3–2.5 m
4¼–8¼ ft

NORTHERN FUR SEAL *Callorhinus ursinus*

Except when breeding, this species lives far offshore in the North Pacific. Males can be over five times heavier than females.

1.5–2.1 m
5–7 ft

CALIFORNIA SEA LION *Zalophus californianus*

Widely recognized as the “performing seal”, this species is agile on land and in water, often leaping partly clear of the surface.

dog-like muzzle
with whiskers

streamlined
body tapers from
shoulder to tail

2–2.4 m
6½–7¾ ft

SOUTHERN SEA LION *Otaria byronia*

Thickset with a blunt face, this resident of S. America and the Falkland Islands in the South Atlantic occasionally hunts co-operatively and may enter rivers in search of fish.

2–3.3 m
6½–11 ft

JUVENILE

ADULT

dark brown
or black pup

black flippers